

Summary of Belarus memories of Tanya Mostkoff

Tatyana (Taiba) Izrailevna Mostkova = Tanya Moskoff, daughter of Israel and Shifra- remained in Russia after family moved to Mexico. Izrailevna is patronymic for Israel and Mostkova is the feminized version of family name.

Mentions fire- before/after probably during revolution 1918/1919. Born "7 or 8 years" prior, so about 1911/1912.

Mother gave birth, perhaps to Mikhail born in 1917, "Lev" was born in 1914. Midwife was named Keilya (Clara) or maybe Rosa. Mijkhail = Miguel Moskoff and Lev/Leb = Luis Moskoff

Older brother Abram was born about 3 years earlier (1908/1909) = Abraham Moskoff

Family was "created about 1908/1908"

Remembers Polish occupation. (NB-google: Following the Polish-Soviet War (1919-1920) and the Treaty of Riga in 1921, a portion of Belarus, known as Western Belorussia, came under Polish occupation, while the rest remained part of the Soviet Union)

Mentions Sadovaya Street and owner of house across street by name of Wolfson.

Lived there until 1928/1929, when father, Abram, mom and kids left.

Lived in the courtyard of the Wolfson house, next to "newly built synagogue on corner surrounded by wooden fence", with an "exit to the market". House was about 20-40 meters across from Slyuch (Slusk) river.

Living with family was cousins Masha and Nina. Mother took in after their own mother died in Saratov from TB. Father was Isaac Bunin.(NB: Masha and Nina were likely second cousins, once removed to Tanya- their mother was Tanya's mother's cousin making Masha and Nina Shifra's 2nd cousins)

The fact is that in the hungry 1920s, the family of my mother's cousin came to us from Saratov - her husband and 2 girls Masha and Nina. Their mother died there of tuberculosis. They settled with us temporarily and the girls, several years older than me, slept with me in this bedroom. The girls' father left to get a job. That's what they say now, but more honestly he went to Minsk to buy something and sell it here at a higher price, i.e. to earn money. Those were the years of

banditry. On the way back, the entire loaded horse-drawn convoy with goods was surrounded by bandits, who tied everyone alive to a tree, doused them with kerosene and set them on fire. That's how Isaac, the father of Masha and Nina Guitiyk, died. And the girls stayed with us forever.

Pinkas of Slutsk: 229. Non-stop tearing over the terrible thing that has happened, "May G-D have mercy on us", in the year 5682 the eve of Tuesday the second day of Shvat (31 January 1922). Ten men from the town of Minsk travelled here with merchandise. On the way on the seventh hour in the evening murderers had fallen on them by the village Dalhinoveh not far from the town Laseh, and killed seven men brutally and then burnt them. Three men survived, wounded. They escaped to the town Ozdeh. And these are the dead: a. The martyr r' REUVEN the son of r' BINYAMIN YALEVITZER twenty-eight years of age. b. The martyr r' YEHUDAH the son of r' ZEV BAGUSHAV [...] years of age. c. **The martyr r' YITSKHAK the son of r' MENDIL BUNIN [...] years of age.** d. The martyr r' AVRAHAM-CHAIM the son of r' [...] SHULMAN from HARESK. e. The martyr r' REUVEN the son of r' YITSKHAK HALEVY KANTAROVITCH. Two more men were buried in the town Laseh. The aforementioned martyrs were buried on Sunday the seventh day of Shvat (5 February 1922) here in the cemetery. They rest by the martyr URIYAH PERELMAN who was killed on Sunday the eleventh day of Tamuz 5681 (17 July 1921). They were buried according to the aforementioned order in row "martyrs" by the cave of the "shaimes" south side. The entire town was shocked over this terrible disaster. May G-D do only good and will never again rebuke in this way. May their souls be bound up in the bond of everlasting life among the righteous souls, May death be consumed... Amen.

Tanya's mother's family was Polyak but she did not know where her family was. Polyaks were "rich people". Pesya Polak was Tanya's grandmother. Pesya married a poor, but intelligent guy- Nakhmani Korukhilmay (perhaps mistranslation of Boruchovich), with whom she had 11 children, only two of which survived to old age.

Pinkas: 201. On the holy day of Shabat the third day of Nisan (1 April 1922) passed away the woman **Mrs. PESHEH the daughter of the rabbi mh"r Y' MIKHAL POLAK the wife of r' NAKHMAN BARUKHOVITCH.** She rests by the woman Mrs. ZLATEH who passed away on Wednesday the tenth day of the aforementioned Shvat (8 February 1922) row "twenty-seven" b"k south side.

The family's haberdashery shop was burned down during the revolution.

Grandmother Khaya lived with family. Khaya was the mother of Tanya's father Isrol Moskov. Tanya remembers Israel, her father, the youngest son born in 1880. Eldest daughter Taibe, son Motel, daughter Ginda and youngest son Eizer (and others). She does not remember Khaya's husband (paternal grandfather) Leiba.

??870. On the aforementioned day the first day of "rosh-khodesh" Adar b' (3 March 1919) passed away in an institution the elderly woman Mrs. CHAYA-HENYA the daughter of mh"r DAVID the wife of r' **ZEV VOLF ITSKOVITS** from Oretesheh and she rests by the elderly woman who passed away on the holy day of Shabat the fifteenth day of the aforementioned Adar a' (15 February 1919) row "twenty-seven" b"k to the south side. *Could this be Khaya? The Iskovits name comes up in later paragraphs when Shifra is complaining to Israel and Israel's nephew. However, if this woman is Chaya Iskovits, then Israels' paternal name would be the same and not Mostkov.*

Around the end of 1800's Tanya's older brothers (note, this probably should be "uncles", and 15 year old "future dad" went to Mississippi, doing crafts, small trades and peddling.

Her dad, about aged 25 went back to Russia and became engaged to 27 year old future mother (NB: Shifra) in about 1907. This would put Israel's birthdate around 1882 with Shifra's about 1880.

Shifra Nakhmanova Borukhovich was Tanya's mother. Shifra's father (Tanya's maternal grandfather lived near the city of Slutsk on the outskirts of Ostrov. Grandfather Nakhman and his brother (Yenta Moiseyevna's father) studied in a cheder and then in a yeshiva - a higher religious school.

Perhaps Movsha is Yenta's father???

BORUKHOVICH, Yenta	Movsha, - Feiga, - -	3/1/1888 2Shvat	Bobruysk Bobruisk Minsk	-	Bobruysk 1888 F2	- - NHABMinsk/1520/7/1
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ORUKHOVICH, Iakha	Movsha, Abram Feiga, Bentsian -	17/8/1884 -	Bobruysk Bobruisk Minsk	Father registered in Slutsk. witnessing record has not been preserved, the record taken later in 1907	Bobruysk 1884 F37	- - NHABMinsk/1520/7/3 95
BORUKHOVICH, Girsha	Movsha, Borukh Feiglia, - -	11/12/1885 -	Bobruysk Bobruisk Minsk	circumcision was performed by GALANT Khaim, KHENKIN Iser	Bobruysk 1885 M202	- - NHABMinsk/1520/7/3 124

If this is indeed Nakhman's brother, then Movsha also had children named Iakha and Girsha. And Movsha and Nakhman's parents were Abram and Benstian??

Grandma Pesya was given a textile shop as an inheritance, where she lasted only a short time due to her poor health. According to stories, Grandma Pesya gave birth to 11 children, of whom I knew three – my mother, the eldest and favorite daughter Shifra, and the youngest Malka and Mikhail. The rest of the children were spoken of in whispers. One guy was mentally weak and left home, they said, to go to sea, and never returned. The rest of the children died in childhood from various illnesses. Pesya died of kidney disease.

Grandfather was a specialist in furs and other agricultural raw materials. I remember that in his apartment there were always bunches of dried mushrooms, which smelled very delicious. They brought him processed animal skins, and he smoothed them out, assessed them and, never lying, told the true price. His word was law. Later, in the 20s, he was one of the first former owners and small traders who was hired by the Soviet customs... as a specialist with a salary of 25 rubles a month, he was a member of the trade union, which was very honorable.

My mother was smart and businesslike. They said that once their house caught fire, and there were valuable skins in the storeroom. Grandfather jumped up in the night, confused and began to pray to God. My mother, in one nightgown, being already a bride, opened the window and threw out all the goods, i.e. saved grandfather and all his fortune. My mother was drawn to politics, to public life. She participated in mutual aid, was friends with the poor and impoverished people, collected aid for them, and she herself helped everyone as much as she could.

She was friends with Khaya Rabinovich. Her husband was a very educated, but sick and hunchbacked man, and this poor woman was forced to feed her entire large, gifted and poor family alone. Mom helped them all the time, and in her difficult years she helped through people, i.e. collected donations for them. My mother was not a member of the Bund party, but she was close to them and close to the revolutionary movement. Why did such a nice and smart woman stay a maid for so long? It happens. She had a man who loved her very much, but he was a shoemaker and not a match for her - prestige. It was very important then - parents did not allow her to take below her class. When Mom first met Dad, she was attracted by his dashing appearance, composure, but his American character did not escape her gaze either. But the time came to start a family, and they got married. Mom was given a small dowry - a haberdashery shop with ties, buttons, ribbons, which stood in boxes not only in the shop, but also under the bed at home.

Tanya remembers when dad, mom and dad's nephew - already a young man of 17-18 years old, Tsukovich Israel, the son of the elder sister. Mom in bitter tears tells him that dad does not give her money to live on and she has nothing to feed the children, and there were already four of them then and soon a fifth appeared.

At some point, Tanya left to live with her grandfather after the death of Pesya. "until I was 16, when I got on the Slutsk-Moscow train with a transfer, I think, in Osipovichi, Minsk and, I think, Smolensk and arrived in the cobblestone - Belorussky railway station – Moscow"

A girl named Dveira-Dora, my father's niece, came to visit us. My mother was very, very kind and pitied everyone. Some misfortune happened at home, maybe she was left an orphan and was sent to us. She was beautiful and stately, and I was 10 years old. I was sent to the pharmacy for medicine, and I was embarrassed to open the door, I sat on the street and did not dare knock and open the door of the pharmacy – my uncle (my mother's cousin Chaim Yudya) worked there as a pharmacist. And so I sat. Then I ran home and lied that I had been there, that there was no medicine, but they told me – no need anymore! I did not understand at first and

was even glad that it was not necessary. Looking at my mother's gloomy face, I understood. Dveira was already dead in the bedroom. She died of dysentery. I remember that my mother was tearing her hair out, she was also pregnant. We children were strictly – strictly ordered not to pick and eat apples. In August 1921, my mother gave birth to a daughter and she was named Dveira (Dora).

Aunt Malka came from Moscow, she studied at the Krupskaya Academy. This was, however, already in 1925, when I was 14 years old.

I would like to describe our life when I was 10-13 years old in my parents' family, because then the family broke up, my father left, and my grandfather took me in. So, my mother gave birth to the youngest - a girl Dveyra-Dora in August 1921. It was a sad time. Our haberdashery shop burned down, and in general the small seller - my father, already poor, ceased to exist.

Mentions friends Perla Rabinovich and other Rabinovich children, Khana, Sarochka and Polinochka.

Wolfson's youngest daughter was Bertochka.

Aunt Malka from Moscow and her younger brother Mikhail, who studied at the medical institute in Leningrad and, without the consent of his parents and all his relatives, suddenly married Khaya Pastron, a lively girl and, as they said around – not for him (Genya's mother).

My teacher was Mogilevsky Meilakh and we called him "teacher Meilakh", He had a niece – Liza Charnaya, who was my bosom friend, Liza's father was a dentist.

I also looked for my second cousins Manya and Nina (Nekhamka) in Leningrad,

On January 22, 1924, in the evening, Aunt Malka came to us and told us that Lenin had died.

In this club I became friends with Lenchka Rabinovich, with Perlechka, my age, and her older sister Sarochka. The club's leadership included senior comrades, respected by us and very, very committed to the cause of the club, such as Movshovich, Lisnyansky, Rabinovich.

The club's active members were Sara Rabinovich, Movshovich (Fanya Iosifovna's husband).

Slutsk 1911–1926

My school friend Etl Muhler and I are sitting on the terrace of their small wooden house and studying

Sarah Rabinovich is coming.” Boris, their brother, was the pride of the family, and he was rarely at home. Somewhere in the shtetl he had a fiancée, Tsilya.

My two aunts lived in Moscow – Enta Moiseyevna, who graduated from the Krupskaya Academy, and Aunt Malka, my mother’s sister. The Pastrons also lived in Moscow – Genya Borukhovich’s mother and her uncles and aunts.

I remember the manorial apartment on Proletarskaya Street. This apartment was confiscated from the rich people who left the revolution and given to Boris for use.

The last thing I remember about my mother's house is my father's departure. We are all sitting in the cart, my father, my mother and the five of us children. Dorochka is 4-5 years old. I am already a young lady, I am a little ashamed to ride in the cart, but I understand that I have to be with my mother, with the children and we are riding far away to the station, along Proletarskaya Street, past our club. Several other men are riding with my father. They are riding from Russia to Mexico, and my mother and we are staying behind.

The following year, several more families went to Mexico, and dad ordered Abram to be sent with them, which mom did. He didn’t want to study, there was nowhere to work, and dad lived alone there and he had to be helped to earn money. 4 Our family before dad’s departure, 1925.

One winter morning bitterness came to the house. Grandfather's son, beloved and only, handsome and talented, an employee - an inspector of the Belarusian People's Commissariat of Education in Minsk - committed suicide - hanged himself with a towel in his room. It was difficult to find the reasons, but grandfather's grief knew no bounds. He cut all his clothes, sent ashes to his gray head, sat on the floor and cried. My mother and aunt Malka got sick. His wife and daughter Genya lived in Moscow. Malka graduated from the Academy. Krupskaya in Moscow and was appointed inspector of education in Bobruisk. Her fiancé cheated on her - he married her friend. By this time Faivel Kharak appeared, who loved Malka very much, was a good, calm person, but could not extinguish the fire of suffering in Malka's soul. Faivel moved into Grandpa's apartment to stay with him when I went to study in Moscow.

During the first winter holidays, and they were very short for me, I did not go home to Mom, but ... to some place near Minsk. Dveira Ostrovskaya, HIS older sister, lived there, who also graduated from the Minsk Jewish Pedagogical College and worked there as a teacher

How much I've already heard about Moscow, and I'll live there, for now with Aunt Yenta, and then I'll enroll, of course I'll have a dorm.

I leave for Moscow, 1926.

(Google) The Saratov Region is located in the southeastern section of European Russia in the Lower Volga area. It borders on the Volgograd, Voronezh, Tambov, Penza, Ulyanovsk, Samara and Orenburg regions; it also shares a state border with Kazakhstan.